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GUARDIAN, CATCHER, ARCHITECT: HOW AI RESHAPES THE ROLES OF THE PSYCHOMETRICIAN



Presented by Cambium Assessment

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AI changes not only what psychometricians need to know, but what behavioral skills are required

Three archetypal roles in a testing company

- Not exhaustive (for example, the Communicator).
- Most psychometricians combine several, and a healthy organization needs them in balance.



The Guardian

Safeguards the reliability, validity, and fairness of tests; treats the Standards as first principles.

With AI

Must reckon with evolving standards



The Catcher

Operational vigilance: detail-oriented, conscientious, risk-averse; works best when tasks and success criteria are well defined.

With AI

From box-ticking to forensics



The Architect

Bridges psychometrics with data science and emerging technology; high on openness; restless to redesign systems rather than run them.

With AI

Design to prototype, fast; must ground designs in measurement principles

Behavioral skill profiles shift differently for each archetype

Archetype	Before AI	With AI, gains weight
Guardian 	Adherence; judging fit to a stable framework	Receptiveness to new methods; explaining why a principle matters; tolerance for ambiguity
Catcher 	Diligence; thoroughness in checking outputs	Anticipating failure modes; comfort with open-ended problems; calibrated trust in automation
Architect 	Creativity; persistence in building	Self-skepticism; verification discipline; owning results one did not produce by hand

A deeper challenge for the Guardian

What test theory assumed

- We cannot observe a person all the time, across all situations
- So we sample behavior under standardized conditions
- And infer a trait that predicts behavior across situations

AI questions an assumption on which the framework itself was built.

What AI makes possible

- Behavior observed across time and contexts
- Many observations, each with limited precision
- **Calls for dynamic measurement models**

The unresolved problem

Developing behavioral skills may require a different approach than training cognitive skills.

What should professional development look like when the goal is new ways of working, not new knowledge?